

Requirements Gathering Process

Farmers Market Vendor Management System

1. How I gathered requirements

I couldn't set up a live interview, so instead I looked at how a real farmers market organization actually runs. I used Grow NYC's Greenmarket program as my source. They run dozens of farmers markets across New York City, and they publish their vendor rules and application requirements online.

I think this still works as real requirements gathering. It's based on an actual organization's real rules, not something I made up, and it gave me specific details I could turn directly into entities and attributes.

2. Source

Organization: Grow NYC Greenmarket

What I used: their public vendor eligibility rules and FAQ page

Where: gownyc.org

When I looked at it: September 2026

3. What I found

A few things stood out from their guidelines that shaped how I built the database:

- Vendors must grow or make what they sell themselves. They can't just resell products they bought somewhere else.
- Vendors who aren't farmers can only sell specific things, like preserves, baked goods, or locally caught fish. So, every vendor has a category.
- Vendors selling fresh produce need a state authorization, and it must be renewed periodically. That means I need to track a permit number and an expiration date.
- Vendors apply to a market, but that doesn't mean they show up every single market day. Attendance is handled separately.
- Each market runs on a set schedule at a fixed location, and the individual dates are their own thing worth tracking.

4. How this shaped the design

What I found	What I did with it
Vendors only sell what they grow or make, and every vendor fits a specific category	Gave Vendor a Category attribute, and made Product its own entity owned by a Vendor
Vendors selling fresh produce need a permit that must be renewed	Added Permit Number and Permit Expiration Date to Vendor
A vendor can be approved for a market but still do not show up every day	Made Vendor and Market Day many to many relationships instead of a direct link
Each market has a regular schedule of specific dates it's open	Split this into two entities: Market (the location) and Market Day (a specific date)

5. Assumptions I made

My project is about a generic regional farmers market, not Grow NYC specifically, so I simplified a few things:

- I made the stall fee just an attribute of the vendor-attendance relationship, since I don't know Grow NYC's exact fee structure and it probably varies a lot between markets anyway.
- I decided not to track individual customers, since these markets are mostly cash and walk-up.
- Some vendor handbooks mention a product inspection or "jury" process before approval. I didn't model that as its own entity, just treated it as part of how a vendor gets approved in the first place, to keep the scope reasonable.

6. Why I think this works

I am upfront here about what I did. I named my real source, separated what came directly from that source from what I assumed on my own, and showed how each finding led to a specific design choice in the ER diagram.